INC-2026-01-22: Nightly batch job that settles captured payments with acquir degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV2 · service settlement-worker · author m.oyelaran

Started 2026-01-22T13:00:00Z · detected 2026-01-22T13:11:00Z · resolved 2026-01-22T13:50:00Z

Customer impact

Settlement for 48,900 captured payments was delayed by 24 hours. Merchant payouts arrived one business day late.

Root cause

The nightly settlement batch read the acquirer cut-off time from the pod's local timezone rather than UTC, so the batch ran one hour late and missed the acquirer window.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release settle-2.1.4, deployed to settlement-worker. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

settlement-worker. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on settlement-worker.

Timeline (UTC)

13:00 — Release settle-2.1.4 completed rollout earlier in the day.

13:00 — First symptoms observed on settlement-worker.

13:11 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for settlement-worker.

13:41 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

13:50 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Review the third-party contract for change notification.

• Add saturation alerting to settlement-worker at 80% of limits.

• Require a load test for configuration changes of this class.